



14th Annual

Gloria L. Negri

FIRST AMENDMENT
INSTITUTE

Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute
October 20-22, 2024 | Northeastern University | Boston

Table of Contents

About the Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute	3
About Gloria L. Negri	4
Former Fellows	7
Schedule	10
Keynote Speakers	13
Faculty and Other Speakers	16
2024 Fellows	23
2024 Student Fellows	25

Program Sponsors, Contributors and Special Recognition

The Rhode Island Foundation	2
Academy of New England Journalists	6
Boston University	12
Northeastern University	14
WCVB Boston	20
Hearst Connecticut Media Group	22
The Robertson Foundation	26
The Boston Globe Foundation	26
Paul and Ann Sagan	26
The Boston Globe	28

Important Information

Institute Main Page

www.nefac.org/negri-institute-2024

Institute Schedule, Documents and Presentations

www.nefac.org/negri-institute-2024-curriculum

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The most important thing
you can do while you're here
is to ensure the world will be
better when you're not.

Proud to support the work of the
New England First Amendment Coalition



RHODE ISLAND
FOUNDATION

About the Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute

Named after the late trail-blazing Boston Globe journalist, the Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute (formerly the New England First Amendment Institute) is an annual, multi-day, intensive training program on freedom of information law and investigative reporting techniques. It is offered each year exclusively to 25 working New England journalists and a select group of student journalists.

The Negri Institute is provided by the New England First Amendment Coalition. It gives editors, reporters and producers the support and training necessary to become accomplished investigative journalists, well versed in the access laws that govern today's difficult reporting landscape. Many exceptional, award-winning journalists and outstanding First Amendment attorneys give their time to make the Negri Institute an extraordinary learning experience. Presenters and fellows span print, broadcast and online media. A goal of the Negri Institute is to change the culture of journalism in New England by way of the ripple effect — our fellows are required to share what they have learned with colleagues at their media outlets.

WHO IS IT FOR? The Institute is designed for both up-and-coming and veteran print, digital and broadcast journalists working in the region. Applicants should have at least two years of professional news reporting experi-

ence and long-term plans to stay within the profession.

WHAT DOES IT COST? The fellows selected for this year's Institute will attend at no cost. A limited number of scholarships are available to cover hotel and travel expenses, if necessary to attend.

SUPPORTERS

Primary support for our Institute is generously provided by the following:



Northeastern University



RHODE ISLAND
FOUNDATION



NEFAC appreciates the support of all its donors and Sustaining Members. In addition to those named above, we would like to thank the following Leadership Circle donors and Major Supporters for their contributions: The Boston Globe, Paul and Ann Sagan, the Robertson Foundation, Hearst Connecticut Media Group and WCVB-Boston.



Testimonials

NEFAC taught me reporting skills I never acquired when working toward a media degree in college. Since attending the Institute, I have filled out more public records requests with more confidence. NEFAC didn't just teach me core skills. It also taught me how to be a digital-savvy journalist through data analysis and web scraping. These skills are crucial for journalists.

There is no question that NEFAC training has allowed me to better keep an eye on the public's business and hold powerful interests to account. NEFAC trainings have given me the confidence to push back on official narratives and shown me strategies I have used to pursue public information that officials have tried to shield from view.

The Institute opened my eyes to different ways stories can be shared. I also gained a variety of new skills including web scraping data, how to pitch a solid climate change story, and the rights journalists have to public records. For me, attending the classes was instrumental for my growth as an investigative journalist.

About Gloria L. Negri

Indispensable and Unstoppable, Gloria Negri Was at the Heart of the Globe

By Thomas Farragher

There had been a shooting on the North Shore and as the all-male editors of The Boston Globe scanned their sparkling new newsroom on Morrissey Boulevard on that sleepy Saturday afternoon in the late 1950s, their options for quick coverage were slim.

The only reporter in sight was the new kid, a young woman fresh from the Miami Herald, a Brown University graduate named Gloria Negri. Surely they couldn't send a woman to a grisly crime scene, could they?

And then Negri walked up to the city desk and said something she would repeat countless times over the next half century. "Send me," she said.

When President Kennedy and his wife, Jacqueline, lost their infant son in August 1963 it was

an eternally sad story that required just the right touch. "Send me," Gloria said.

When young women were turning up dead in their Boston apartments, strangled by a madman on the loose, the Globe dreamed up an idea that seems insane now. Let's put a woman on a park bench in the South End as bait for the killer. "Send me," Gloria said.

When men blasted off from Cape Kennedy, bound for the moon, somebody had to go to Florida to cover it. "Send me," Gloria said.

Race riots. Apartheid. Chappaquiddick. Assassinations. Papal visits. Pen-nant fever at Fenway Park. Presidential campaigns. The theft of a bronzed duckling at the Public Garden. Hun-

dreds of deftly written obituaries, carefully crafted stories now framed by grateful families across Eastern Massachusetts.

All of it — the work of a pioneering newspaper woman — now carefully tucked into yellowing scrapbooks be-

wonderfully absent-minded. She also was a poet at her keyboard. The woman could flat-out write. Lyrical.

She was a columnist for the old Evening Globe, a job shoehorned between regular assignments and coverage of breaking news. She would write late at night on her trusty Royal typewriter and — very early in the morning — summon Globe photographer Dan Sheehan to collect her copy and drive it to the Globe for publication that afternoon.

She was a world-class procrastinator. The woman simply could not — would not — make up her mind.

Here she is from a May 1973 Globe column headlined, so aptly, "Manana."

"A few years ago, I was invited to join some

friends on a trip to Australia. I couldn't make up my mind to go until an hour before the flight left Boston. The travel agency had to speed my ticket over by special delivery. When I got to Sydney, my friends had left three days earlier. Never did catch up with them, though I came close in Fiji."

In 1997, I became Gloria's colleague and, in short order, her friend. We lived within a mile of each other. My kids mowed her lawn and shoveled her snow. And she would dote on them afterward with sweets and soft drinks. They learned that she appreciated the chores they did for her. But what she really loved was their company.

And what company it was.

Over Saturday afternoon beers at



neath her bed, and preserved on microfilm for posterity. It is the legacy of a woman who dedicated her life to this newspaper.

I ask for your indulgence today as we pay tribute to one of our own. If you're reading this, you were part of her extended family. The Boston Globe was in many ways Gloria's home. Her living room. Her den. Her kitchen. The place where she grew up.

Gloria died on Sunday morning as a fresh blanket of snow covered a breathtaking hillside in Hingham outside her window and Christmas carols played softly in the background.

She was whip-smart, funny, feisty, stubborn, loyal, deeply appreciative of any kindness to come her way, and



her kitchen table, the stories of Gloria's life and career spilled out in delightful detail.

If you had pulled up a chair next to me, here's some of what you would have heard.

She sipped whiskey at the LBJ ranch in Texas with Lady Bird Johnson, where her dress somehow got ripped and repair work was done with the help of LBJ's daughters.

She spent a year in South Africa, once driving all night across bush coun-

try for an interview with Desmond Tutu.

She went on a morning run with Joe Frazier in 1971 when he was training for his titanic fight with Muhammad Ali.

She rode an elephant in the circus, rang the Salvation Army bell over a red kettle at Christmastime, followed Margaret Heckler to Dublin, flew to Northern Italy when a major earthquake struck, and had to be told to leave Saigon during the height of the Vietnam War.

"Gloria Negri wants to stay," members of the Associated Press's Saigon bureau wrote to their superiors in New York, who forwarded the message to Globe publisher Bill Taylor in Boston.

Taylor, who feared for her life, had a succinct reply: "No," he wrote back.

So Gloria came back to Boston, much to the delight of her editors.

"I could send you out to cover clothes drying on a clothes line and you'd come back with a great story," an editor once told her. It was a compliment any reporter would treasure. And she did.

Over the past 20 years, at doctor's appointments with Gloria or during our

long commutes to and from the South Shore, I marveled at the length and breadth of her career.

You can learn a lot about a person during times like those. I learned that Gloria first heard George Gershwin's "Rhapsody in Blue," his 1924 musical composition, as a young girl while on a train heading for Boston. She loved it.

I learned that she once, with an old boyfriend, sneaked a shaker full of martinis into the bleachers at Fenway Park — not far from her beloved home on the "Fabulous Fenway." It helped to cement her lifelong love of the Red Sox.

I learned that once, on assignment for the Globe, she interviewed Officer Obie on Main Street in Stockbridge. Obie is featured in the Arlo Guthrie song "Alice's Restaurant," and that interview has always struck me as an emblem of Gloria's far-flung, remarkable journalism career.

Even in the twilight of her 53-year Globe career, Gloria told me that she still could feel the competitiveness and the thrill of producing stories just as she had done as a kid fresh out of college.

"And when the presses are rolling at night, I still feel that tingle," she said.

Gloria had a stock answer whenever I asked, as I did nearly every day, "How are you doing?"

"Oh, I'm falling apart at the seams," she would answer without fail.

It wasn't true. Until it was.

When Gloria died the other morning, there was a beautiful picture of her beloved mother hanging on the wall over her bed.

Shortly before she drew her last breath, she sat up and seemed to reach for that picture.

"I want my mother," she often told me in recent weeks.

And the image of that reunion gives me comfort — gives comfort to her entire Globe family — as we say goodbye to a Boston Globe original, my friend, the great Gloria Negri.

This tribute to Gloria originally appeared in The Boston Globe. It is republished here with permission.

The Academy of New England Journalists

Proud sponsor of the
Gloria L. Negri
First Amendment Institute

The Academy of New England Journalists is a proud sponsor of The Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute. Congratulations to the 2024 Negri Institute fellows, who are among the very best and brightest journalists in our six-state region.

The first-class training provided at the Institute is an investment in New England's newsrooms. There has never been a more critical time for journalists to dig deep in order to keep those in power honest and accountable to the voters and taxpayers. That's what organizations like NEFAC and the Academy are all about.

Richard K. Lodge, *Chair*
Academy of New England Journalists



Founded in 1960, the Academy of New England Journalists honors -- with the ***Yankee Quill Award*** -- those journalists from the region who have made extraordinary contributions to a free press and the welfare of their communities. Each year the Academy's Selection Committee, which is comprised of past Quill winners and representatives of New England journalism organizations, select recipients of the award.

The Yankee Quill is the highest honor bestowed on journalists in our region, recognizing the lifetime achievement of those who have had a broad influence for good, both inside and outside the newsroom.

Former Fellows

CONNECTICUT

2011

Richard Campbell

The Register Citizen

Jenna Cho

The Day

JC Reindl

The Day

Alexandra Sanders

New Haven Register

Julie Stagis

Hartford Courant

2012

Shawn Beals

Hartford Courant

Beau Berman

WTIC-TV

Alexander Goldstein

The Day

Kevin Litten

Republican-American

Erin Logan

WTNH

Fran Silverman

Hearst Newspapers

2013

Lisa Backus

The Bristol Press

Jenna Carlesso

Hartford Courant

Tina Detelj

WTNH

Jessica Glenza

The Register Citizen

Maggie Gordon

Hearst Newspapers

David Iversen

WTNH

Alec Johnson

Republican-American

Viktoria Sundqvist

The Middletown Press

2014

Jason Bagley

TruthInAdvertising

Kelly Catalfamo

The Day

Jennifer Swift

New Haven Register

Tess Townsend

The Day

2015

Lindsay Boyle

The Day

Suzanne Carlson

Hartford Courant

Susan Haigh

The Associated Press

Esteban Hernandez

New Haven Register

Patrick Skahill

WNPR-Connecticut

2016

Julia Bergman

The Day

Anna Bisaro

New Haven Register

Mikaela Porter

Hartford Courant

2017

Stephen Busemeyer

Hartford Courant

Jill Konopka

WVIT-Hartford

Kaitlyn Krasselt

Norwalk Hour

Martha Shanahan

The Day

2018

Skylar Frazer

New Britain Herald

Ben Lambert

New Haven Register

Barry Lytton

The Stamford Advocate

Erica Moser

The Day

2019

Kimberly Drelich

The Day

Meghan Friedmann

Hearst Connecticut

Jo Krocker

Hearst Connecticut

Justin Papp

Hearst Connecticut

2020

Tatiana Flowers

Hearst Connecticut

Peter Yankowski

Hearst Connecticut

2021

Verónica Del Valle

Hearst Connecticut

Currie Engel

Hearst Connecticut

Alex Putterman

Hartford Courant

Elizabeth Regan

The Day

2022

Richard Chumney

Hearst Connecticut

Emily DiSalvo

Hearst Connecticut

Walter Smith

Randolph

Connecticut Public

Sten Spinella

The Day

2023

Amy Coval

Hearst Connecticut

Media Group

Ashad Hajela

Connecticut Public

Kate Seltzer

Connecticut Public

Jared Weber

Hearst Connecticut

Media Group

MAINE

2011

Susan Cover

Maine Today

Emily Guerin

The Forecaster

Jesse Nankin

Watchdog New England

Eric Russell

Bangor Daily News

2012

Will Graff

The Forecaster

Lindsay Tice

Sun Journal

2013

Matthew Curren

WGME

David Harry

The Forecaster

2014

Jon Chrisos

CBS13/Fox23

Michael Shepherd

Kennebec Journal

2015

Jordan Bailey

Courier Publications

Nate Holst

WMTW-Portland

David Sherwood

Maine Center for

Public Interest

Reporting

2016

Matthew Daigle

Sun Journal

Stephanie Grinnell

The Republican Journal

Kyle Jones

WMTW News

Joshua Moore

Maine Center for

Public Interest

Reporting

Marina Villeneuve

Associated Press

2017

Abigail Adams

Lincoln County News

Charles Eichacker

Kennebec Journal

Callie Ferguson

The Forecaster

2018

Anne Berleant

Penobscot Bay Press

Joe Glauber

WMTW-Portland

Rachel Ohm

Morning Sentinel

Amanda Post

WGME-Portland

2019

Sarah Craighead

Dedmon

Machias Valley

News Observer

Dan Lampariello

WGME-Portland

Patty Wight

Maine Public Radio

2020

Molly Shelly

The Morning Sentinel

Terry Stackhouse

WMTW News 8

Andrea Swiedom

Sun Media

2021

Lynda Clancy

Penobscot Bay Pilot

2022

Kaitlyn Budion

Morning Sentinel

Joaquin Contreras

Sun Journal

Emily Duggan

Kennebec Journal

Sawyer Loftus

Bangor Daily News

Kay Neufeld

Sun Media Group

Vanessa Paoletta

Sun Journal

2023

Joseph Charpentier

Sun Journal

Stephanie Grindley

WGME-Portland

Norah Hogan

WMTW-Portland

Zara Norman

Morning Sentinel

Kathleen O'Brien

Bangor Daily News

MASSACHUSETTS

2011

Keith Eddings

Eagle-Tribune

Jim Haddadin

Arlington Advocate

Laura Hutchinson

WWLP 22News

Lyle Moran

Lowell Sun

David Riley

MetroWest Daily News

Rory Schuler

Taunton Daily

Matthew Stout

The Enterprise

2012

Alex Bloom

The Enterprise

George Brennan

Cape Cod Times

Deirdre Fernandes

The Boston Globe

David Eisenstadter

The Transcript

Sarah Favot

Lowell Sun

Martine Powers

The Boston Globe

Patrick Ronan Patriot Ledger	Phil Marcelo Associated Press	Vernal Coleman The Boston Globe	Maddie Hanna Concord Monitor	Casey McDermott New Hampshire
Shaun Sutner Worcester	Tom Relihan The Recorder	Jessica Hill Cape Cod Times	2012	Public Radio
Telegram & Gazette	Susan Spencer Worcester	Jennifer Huberdeau The Berkshire Eagle	Maggie Cassidy Valley News	Paige Sutherland New Hampshire
Ryan Walsh WWLP	Telegram & Gazette	Lucia Maffei Boston Business Journal	Maryalice Gill Nashua Telegraph	Public Radio
2013	Gerry Tuoti Gatehouse Media	Samantha Mercado Patch.com	Meg Heckman Concord Monitor	2018
Doug Fraser Cape Cod Times	2017	Dasia Moore The Boston Globe	Annmarie Timmins Concord Monitor	Breanna Edelstein The Eagle Tribune
Wes Lowery The Boston Globe	Collin Binkley Associated Press	Shira Stoll NBC 10 Boston	2013	Sierra Hubbard The Keene Sentinel
Joshua Miller The Boston Globe	Amanda Drane Berkshire Eagle	Julia Taliesin Somerville Journal	Todd Bookman NH Public Radio	Meg McIntyre The Keene Sentinel
Shawn Musgrave MuckRock	Melissa Hanson MassLive	2021	Sarah Brubeck Valley News	2019
Neena Pathak Schuster Institute	Brad Petrishen Worcester	Dugan Arnett The Boston Globe	Christopher Garofolo Eagle Times	Hadley Barndollar Portsmouth Herald
Neal Simpson The Patriot Ledger	Telegram & Gazette	Greta Jochem The Berkshire Eagle	Kathryn Marchocki Union Leader	Paul Cuno-Booth The Keene Sentinel
Schuyler Velasco Christian Science	Boston Business Journal	Anastasia Lennon New Bedford Light	Kaitlin Mulhere The Keene Sentinel	Mary McIntyre New Hampshire
Monitor	2018	Alex Newman Patch	2014	Public Radio
2014	Sarah Betancourt Boston Institute for	Emma Platoff The Boston Globe	Emily Corwin NH Public Radio	Leah Willingham Concord Monitor
Sean F. Driscoll Cape Cod Times	Nonprofit Journalism	Tiana Woodard The Boston Globe	Alyssa Dandrea The Keene Sentinel	2020
Beryl Lipton MuckRock	Michael Bonner The Standard Times	2022	Nora Doyle-Burr Valley News	Olivia Belanger The Kenne Sentinel
Priyanka McCluskey The Boston Globe	Lisa Creamer WBUR-Boston	Marco Cartolano Worcester	Peter McGuire Forecaster Newspapers	Madeline Hughes The Eagle-Tribune
Alexa Mills The Boston Globe	Dialynn Dwyer Boston.com	Audrey Cooney Fall River Herald News	Kerry Miller Eagle Times	Alexander LaCasse Seacoast Media Group
Alex Ruppenthal Medford Transcript	Jennifer Lu Independent	Samantha Gross The Boston Globe	2015	2021
Eli Sherman Waltham News Tribune	Angela Rowlings Boston Herald	Faith Imafidon Boston Neighborhood	Jeremy Blackman Concord Monitor	Julia Furukawa New Hampshire
2015	Bridget Turcotte The Daily Item	2023	Megan Doyle Concord Monitor	Public Radio
Samantha Allen Worcester	Grant Welker Worcester	Toni Caushi Worcester	Rob Wolfe Valley News	Amanda Gokee New Hampshire Bulletin
Telegram & Gazette	Business Journal	Telegram & Gazette	2016	Cassidy Jensen Concord Monitor
Jonathan Dame GateHouse Media	2019	Theresa Gaffney STAT	Peter Biello New Hampshire	Jordan Phelan Eagle Times
Nicole Dunga The Boston Globe	Amanda Burke Fall River Herald News	Peter O'Neil Needham Observer	Public Radio	Jack Rooney Keene Sentinel
Jenna Fisher GateHouse Media	Jo C. Goode Fall River Herald News	Julian E.J. Sorapuru The Boston Globe	Tim Camerato Valley News	2022
Allison Manning Boston.com	Zoe Greenberg The Boston Globe	NEW HAMPSHIRE	Meghan Foley The Keene Sentinel	Ryan Spencer Keene Sentinel
Jordan Mayblum Wellesley Townsman	Gal Tziperman Lotan The Boston Globe	2011	Allie Morris Concord Monitor	Michaela Towfighi Concord Monitor
Jan Ransom The Boston Globe	Haven Berkshire Eagle	Joseph Cote Nashua Telegraph	Ella Nilsen Concord Monitor	2023
2016	2020	Mark Davis Valley News	2017	Jamie Costa Concord Monitor
Zeninjor Enwemeka WBUR	Dusty Christensen Daily Hampshire		Caitlin Andrews Concord Monitor	Hunter Oberst The Keene Sentinel
Jordan Frias Boston Herald	Gazette		Allison DeAngelis Eagle-Tribune	Olivia Richardson New Hampshire
				Public Radio

RHODE ISLAND

2011

Amanda Milkovits
Providence Journal
David Scharfenberg
Providence Phoenix
Karen Ziner
Providence Journal

2012

Lynn Arditi
Providence Journal
Ian Donniss
Rhode Island
Public Radio
Kathleen Mulvaney
Providence Journal

2013

Bill Malinowski
Providence Journal
Mark Reynolds
Providence Journal

2014

Randal Edgar
Providence Journal
Paul Grimaldi
Providence Journal
Janine Weisman
Newport Mercury

2015

Jennifer Bogdan
Providence Journal
Alex Kuffner
Providence Journal

Steph Machado
WPRI-Providence

2016

Jacqueline Tempera
Providence Journal

2017

Kate Bramson
Providence Journal
Susan Campbell
WPRI-Providence
Derek Gomes
Newport Daily News
Diana Pinzon
WPRI-Providence

2018

Brian Amaral
Providence Journal
Parker Gavigan
WJAR-Cranston
Kim Kalunian
WPRI-Providence

2019

Jessica Botelho
WJAR-Cranston
Laura Damon
The Newport Daily News
Hannah Dickison
WPRI-Providence
Nadine Maya Sebai
The Public's Radio

2020

Madeleine List
Providence Journal

2021

Jeremy Bernfeld
The Public's Radio

Lauren Clem
The Valley Breeze
Sarah Guernelli
WPRI-Providence
Rachel Nunes
Patch

Amy Russo
Providence Journal

2022

Temi-Tope Adeleye
WJAR
Wheeler
Cowperthwaite
Providence Journal
Jacqueline
Gomersall
WPRI

Nina Sparling
The Public's Radio
Zane Wolfgang
Newport Daily News

2023

Colleen Cronin
ecoRI
Savana Dunning
The Newport Daily News

Cheryl Hatch
The Public's Radio
Alexandra Leslie
WPRI-Providence
Stella Lorence
Woonsocket Call

VERMONT

2011

John Briggs
Burlington Free Press
Anne Galloway
Vermont Digger
Shay Totten
Seven Days

2012

Dan D'Ambrosio
Burlington Free Press
Jennifer Cleveland
Caledonian-Record
Andrew Stein
Vermont Digger

2013

Nathan Burgess
Stowe Reporter
Olga Peters
The Commons
Jennifer Reading
WCAX

2014

Taylor Dobbs
Vermont Public Radio
Abby Ledoux
Milton Independent
Allison Teague
The Commons

2015

April Burbank
Burlington Free Press
Lola Duffort
Rutland Herald
Lesley Engle
Fox44/ABC22

Courtney Lamdin
Milton Independent

2016

Jess Aloe
Burlington Free Press

Colin Flanders
The Essex Reporter
and Colchester Sun
Stephanie Gorin
NBC5-Vermont
Katie Jickling
The Herald

Elizabeth Murray
Burlington Free Press

2017

Alicia Freese
Seven Days
Tommy Gardner
Stowe Reporter
Hilary Niles
Independent

Adam Silverman
Burlington Free Press

Greg Sukiennik
New England
Newspapers

2018

Catherine Buni
Independent
Staci DaSilva
WFFF-Burlington
Xander Landen
VTDigger

2019

Liam Elder-Connors
Vermont Public Radio
Christopher Mays
Brattleboro Reformer
Alex Nuti-de Biasi
Journal Opinion
Orrin Schonfeld
WPTZ-Burlington
Cat Viglienzoni
WCAX-Burlington

2020

Devin Bates
Local 22/44
Tom Garriss
WPTZ NBC 5
Anna Merriman
Valley News
Christopher Ross
Addison County
Independent

Tiffany Tan

Bennington Banner
2021

Dom Amato
WCAX-Burlington
Jack Lyons
VT Digger

2022

April Barton
Burlington Free Press
Kevin Gaiss
WCAX
Michael
Hoey-Lukakis
WVNY/WFFF
Lilly St. Angelo
Burlington Free Press

2023

Sophia
Buckley-Clement
Rutland Herald
Corey McDonald
Vermont Community
Newspapers
Katy Savage
Mountain Times
Megan Stewart
Burlington Free Press

REGIONAL

2021

Maya Ergas
Shwayder
New England
Public Media
Kyle Stucker
Gannett New England

STUDENT

2023

Susan Azizi
Salve Regina University
Noble Brigham
Brown University
Lauren Drapeau
University of
Rhode Island
Tyler Jackman
Rhode Island College

“NEFAC Mentors helped support me through the beginning of my first reporting job. I felt encouraged by my mentor and know we’ll stay in touch into the future.”

Learn more at nefac.org/mentors



Schedule

Local Programming

CONNECTICUT

Oct. 18 | 2 p.m.

ACLU of Connecticut

765 Asylum Avenue, Hartford

Dan Barrett | ACLU of Connecticut
Mike Savino | NBC Connecticut

MAINE

Oct. 15 | 2 p.m.

Preti Flaherty

45 Memorial Circle #401, Augusta

Judith Meyer | Sun Media Group
Sigmund Schutz | Preti Flaherty

MASSACHUSETTS

Oct. 15 | 12:30 p.m.

WBUR

890 Commonwealth Avenue, Boston

Peter J. Caruso, Sr. | Caruso & Caruso
Todd Wallack | WBUR-Boston

NEW HAMPSHIRE

Oct. 15 | 3 p.m.

ACLU of New Hampshire

18 Low Avenue, Concord

Gilles Bissonnette | ACLU of NH
Paul Cuno-Booth | NH Public Radio

RHODE ISLAND

Oct. 17 | 12 p.m.

Oliverio & Marcaccio

30 Romano Vineyard Way, N. Kingstown

Ray Marcaccio | Oliverio & Marcaccio
Eli Sherman | WPRI-Providence

VERMONT

Oct. 17 | 10 a.m.

Seven Days

255 So. Champlain Street, Burlington

Harrison Stark | ACLU of Vermont
Courtney Lamdin | Seven Days

Remote Programming

MEET AND GREET

TWO TRUTHS AND A LIE

Oct. 8 | 7 p.m.

Megan Sherman | Westside Events

INTRODUCTION TO R PREP SESSION

Oct. 15 | 9:30 a.m.

Sharon Machlis



Northeastern University

OCTOBER 20

2:00 Registration

Curry Student Center – Room 333

2:30 – 2:45 Introductions

Curry Student Center – Room 333

2:45 – 3:00 Break

3:00 – 4:00 Keynote Speaker

Curry Student Center – Room 333

Jill Abramson | Northeastern University, The New York Times (formerly)

Introduction: Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC President

5:45 – 8:00 Networking and Dinner

Tuscan Kitchen, 64 Seaport Blvd.

NEFAC will provide transportation from the hotel to the restaurant at 5:15 p.m. and from the restaurant to the hotel at 8:30 p.m.

OCTOBER 21

8:15 – 8:30 Announcements

Curry Student Center – Room 333

8:30 – 9:30 FOI Request Pitfalls and How to Respond

Curry Student Center – Room 333

Jacqueline Rabe Thomas | Hearst Connecticut Media Group
Annmarie Timmins | NHPR

Moderator: Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC President

9:30 – 9:45 Break

9:45 – 11:15 How AI Can Support Local Journalism

Curry Student Center – Room 333

OCTOBER 21 (Continued)

Nikita Roy | ICFJ

Introduction: Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC President

11:15 – 11:30 Break

11:30 – 1:45 Break-Out Classes

11:30 – 12:30 Class 1

12:30 – 12:45 Break / Lunch Served

12:45 – 1:45 Class 2

CLIMATE

Curry Student Center – McLeod 1

Beth Daley | The Conversation

EDUCATION

Curry Student Center – McLeod 2

Deanna Pan | The Boston Globe

BUSINESS REPORTING

Curry Student Center – Room 342

Zeninjor Enwemeka | WBUR

COURTS AND COPS

Curry Student Center – Room 344

John Ellement | The Boston Globe

COVERING TRAGEDY

Curry Student Center – Room 346

Gal Tziperman Lotan | GBH News

1:45 – 2:00 Break

2:00 – 3:30 Intro to Copyright Law and Newsroom Legal Q/A

Curry Student Center – Room 333

Robert A. Bertsche | Klaris Law

Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC

Introductions: Justin Silverman | NEFAC Executive Director

4:45 – 5:45 Former Fellows Panel
The Westin Copley, 10 Huntington Ave.

Temi-Tope Adeleye | WJAR

Dugan Arnett | The Boston Globe

Colleen Cronin | ecoRI

Anastasia Lennon | New Bedford Light

Moderator: Shirley Leung | The Boston Globe

5:45 – 8:30 (or later) Dinner and Keynote Presentation

The Westin Copley, 10 Huntington Ave.

Lauren Chooljian | NH Public Radio

Jason Moon | NH Public Radio

Sigmund D. Schutz | Preti Flaherty

Moderator: Shirley Leung | The Boston Globe

NEFAC will provide transportation from Northeastern University to The Westin Copley at 3:45 p.m.

OCTOBER 22

8:15 – 8:30 Announcements

Curry Student Center – Room 333

8:30 – 10:00 Effective Sourcing

Curry Student Center – Room 333

Jenifer McKim | GBH News Center

for Investigative Reporting

Len Besthoff | NBC Connecticut

Cindy Galli | ABC News

Moderator: Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC President

10:00 – 10:15 Break

10:15 – 12:15 Database Analysis Break-Out Classes

BASIC DATABASE ANALYSIS

Curry Student Center – Room 346

Brooke Williams | Boston University

Andrew Botolino | Boston University

INTRODUCTION TO R

Curry Student Center – Room 344

Sharon Machlis

12:15 – 1:45 Lunch

Curry Student Center – McLeod Suites

12:45 Keynote Speaker

Paul Singer | GBH News

Introduction: Gregory V. Sullivan | NEFAC President

1:45 – 2:30 Photo/Break

Location TBD

2:30 – 3:30 Break-Out Classes

CONFRONTATIONAL INTERVIEWS AND TRANSITION TO A/V

Curry Student Center – Room 346

Mike Beaudet | Northeastern University, WCVB Boston

WRITING WORKSHOP AND NARRATIVE FLOW

Curry Student Center – Room 344

Jenifer McKim | GBH News Center for Investigative Reporting

3:30 – 3:45 Concluding Remarks

Curry Student Center – Room 333

Justin Silverman | NEFAC Executive Director



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Boston University College of Communication

Keynote Speakers



Jill Abramson
Northeastern University

✉ JillAbramson

Jill Abramson leads the Northeastern University Burnes Center for Social Change's Initiative on Investigative Solutions Journalism. She is a journalist who spent 17 years in the most senior editorial positions at The New York Times, where she was the first woman to serve as Washington bureau chief, managing editor, and executive editor. Before joining the Times, she was deputy Washington bureau chief and an investigative reporter covering money and politics at The Wall Street Journal for nine years. She was the editor of Legal Times in Washington, D.C. She is the author of six books, including *Strange Justice*, which she wrote with Jane Mayer and *Merchants of Truth*, a narrative history of the

digital transition of the news media. From 2015-2019 she also wrote a weekly political column for The Guardian. Random House in 2021 and 2022 published two books she wrote for middle-schoolers, *What Is Congress* and *What is the Supreme Court*. Recent articles by Abramson have been published in The New Yorker, The New York Times, The Washington Post, The Boston Globe and the Columbia Journalism Review, among others. She has been a frequent political commentator for BBC News. She has won many journalism awards and a Bok Award for her successful teaching. Prior to joining Northeastern, she taught in Harvard's English department as a lecturer on non-fiction narrative writing and journalism. In past years, she taught undergraduate writing seminars at Yale and Princeton. Abramson is a member of the American Academy of Arts & Sciences and The American Philosophical Society. She served on the boards of the Columbia University School of Journalism, Pro Publica and the Knight-Wallace Foundation. She is a 1976 graduate of Harvard.



Lauren Chooljian
New Hampshire Public Radio

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Lauren Chooljian is a senior reporter/producer at NHPR, the NPR affiliate in New Hampshire. She is a part of NHPR's

DOCUMENT team, a narrative-driven, long form reporting project. She is the host and reporter behind *The 13th Step*, a podcast about sexual misconduct in the addiction treatment industry. The 13th Step was a finalist for the 2024 Pulitzer Prize in Audio reporting. The New Yorker, The Atlantic and Vogue called the show one of the best podcasts of 2023. Her work has won numerous awards, including the prestigious duPont-Columbia award, a National Edward R Murrow award, an RTDNA First Amendment Award and she has been recognized by the Third Coast International Audio Festival.



Jason Moon
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Jason Moon is a senior reporter and producer on NHPR's Document team. He has created documentary podcast series on topics including unsolved murders, secret lists of police officers, and over-

dose deaths that are prosecuted as homicides. Moon's work includes Bear Brook seasons one and two, which together have been downloaded more than 28 million times by listeners in over 150 countries. Stephen King called both seasons, "the best true crime podcasts I've ever heard. Brilliant, involving, hypnotic." The New Yorker magazine called Bear Brook S1 one of the best podcasts of 2018. In 2021, Moon and his colleague Lauren Chooljian were honored with a Third Coast/Richard H. Driehaus Foundation Competition award.



Sigmund D. Schutz
Preti Flaherty

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Sigmund D. Schutz represents the news media in First Amendment matters, defamation and privacy, state and federal

freedom of information, newsgathering and cyber law. As a partner at Preti Flaherty, LLP and media law counsel for the Portland Press Herald/Maine Sunday Telegram for more than 25 years, Schutz has served as counsel in many precedent setting public access cases in Maine. They have involved access to transcripts of 911 calls, the right to attend jury selection in criminal cases in Maine state court, access to "draft" settlement agreements to which the state is a party, access to dash cam police cruiser video and obtaining records of closed law enforcement investigations.



Paul Singer
GBH News

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Paul Singer is the Senior Editor, Equity & Justice at GBH News. Singer previously served as Investigative Editor for the GBH

News Center for Investigative reporting, where he spearheaded GBH's Life After Prison series documenting the challenges faced by thousands of people in Massachusetts who return from incarceration each year. With a group of Boston University students, Singer also led the creation of the interactive project "Mapping the Enslavement History of the Freedom Trail." Prior to moving to Boston in 2018, Singer served as Politics Editor for USA Today, White House Correspondent for the UPI wire service and stage manager/roadie for the National Folk Festival in Lowell (and other cities).



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Northeastern University
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Faculty and Other Speakers



Temi-Tope Adeleye

WJAR

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✕ **TemiTopeReports**

Temi-Tope Adeleye is a multimedia journalist and segment contributor with NBC 10 WJAR in Providence, R.I. Adeleye

graduated with a bachelor's degree in Mass Communications from Western Carolina University and a master's degree in Journalism from Emerson College. During her time with NBC 10, she has covered everything from crime and fatal fires to health and community involvement.



Dugan Arnett

The Boston Globe

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✕ **duganarnett**

Dugan Arnett is an investigative reporter on The Boston Globe's quick strike projects team. Since joining the team in 2021,

his work has spanned a variety of subjects with a focus on government accountability, policing, and the criminal justice system. In 2021, he published a series of stories examining the ripple effects of the previous year's national movement against police misconduct and brutality. Arnett joined the Globe staff as a features writer in 2015 and later worked as a general assignment reporter on the paper's Metro desk. Before arriving in Boston, he spent four years as a features and metro reporter at the Kansas City Star, where he covered topics ranging from a father's tortured quest to prove his son's innocence in a journalist's high-profile slaying, to the young members of Kansas's notorious Westboro Baptist Church.



Dan Barrett

ACLU of Connecticut

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Dan Barrett is the American Civil Liberties Union of Connecticut's legal director. His interests in the law include anonymous speech, freedom of movement,

mass surveillance, and maximizing democratic control of government through open courts and open records. Prior to coming to the ACLU of Connecticut, Barrett directed the litigation at the ACLU of Vermont for seven years and clerked for the Hon. Janet Bond Arterton of the United States District Court for the District of Connecticut.



Mike Beaudet

WCVB, Northeastern University

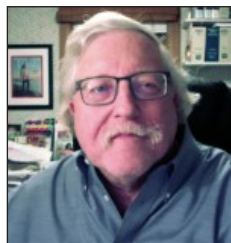
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✕ **Channel_Mike**

Mike Beaudet is a journalism professor at Northeastern University in Boston and an investigative reporter at WCVB-TV,

Boston's ABC affiliate. He's worked in local television news for

more than 30 years. Beaudet started his career in radio covering politics at the Massachusetts State House and also made stops at television stations in Bangor, Maine and Manchester, N.H. Before joining WCVB-TV he was an investigative reporter and anchor at WFXT-TV FOX25 in Boston. Beaudet has won numerous awards, including 21 New England Emmys. His most recent Emmy came in 2024 when he was named Outstanding Investigative Reporter. Beaudet's research at Northeastern focuses on the future of video news storytelling with an emphasis on engaging younger audiences to help strengthen democracy.



Robert A. Bertsche

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✕ **rbertsche**

Robert A. Bertsche, a long-ago newspaperman and magazine editor, heads the Media and First Amendment practice at

Klaris Law in Boston. In his fourth decade as a media lawyer, he handles content review for some of the nation's most prominent magazines and websites; litigates in federal and state courts on behalf of media entities of all kinds; and plays an "outside general counsel" role to a host of print, online, video and documentary film clients. Bertsche has particular expertise in libel, newsgathering, and copyright law. General counsel to the New England Newspaper and Press Association and a board member of NEFAC, Bertsche is nationally ranked in First Amendment law and litigation by Chambers, and "Best Lawyers" has named him Boston's First Amendment "Lawyer of the Year" for 2024, among other honors. He also serves as Board President of the startup nonprofit Needham Observer newspaper, launched earlier this year to help fill a news desert that Gannett left behind. Bertsche graduated, many moons ago, from Wesleyan University and Harvard Law School.



Len Besthoff

NBC Connecticut

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✕ **lennbc**

Len Besthoff is the Chief Investigative Reporter for the NBC Connecticut Investigates team. Since joining NBC Connecticut

in October of 2013, Besthoff has brought change and broken a number of stories with statewide impact including patient abuse at Connecticut's maximum security psychiatric hospital, glitches with the Connecticut's DMV software, and the state's new "Next Generation 911" system. Besthoff has also uncovered wrongdoing by elected officials, and held public utilities accountable for their treatment of ratepayers. Besthoff concentrates on stories using data, records, and whistleblowers to expose waste, corruption, and wrongdoing. He advocates for protecting and improving our state's Freedom of Information statutes, and is on the board of the Connecticut Foundation for Open Government (CFOG). Previously, he worked for WFSB-TV in Hartford for 11 years, and was part of the station's investigative unit, breaking a number of big stories, and receiving a number of awards for his efforts. Besthoff has covered major news stories on the East Coast and New England for 25 years, including 9/11, numerous hurricanes and snowstorms; and major stories in Connecticut, including the violence in Newtown and at Hartford

Distributors in Manchester, along with the arrest of Hartford's mayor. He also worked for WRAL-TV in Raleigh, North Carolina, WDBJ-TV in Roanoke, Virginia, News12 Connecticut in Norwalk, and TV-34 News in Wall Township, New Jersey.



Gilles Bissonnette

ACLU of New Hampshire

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Gilles Bissonnette is the Legal Director at the ACLU of New Hampshire, where he leads a team of three civil rights lawyers. He has litigated cases on the criminalization of poverty, voting, police and government accountability, public records, the First Amendment, immigrants' rights, and criminal justice issues. Bissonnette has testified before the New Hampshire legislature on hundreds of bills impacting civil liberties. He is the 2022 recipient of the New Hampshire Bar Association's Distinguished Service to the Public Award. In 2021, his legal team — along with co-counsel — received the Granite State Advocacy Award from the New Hampshire Association for Justice.



Andrew Botolino

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Andrew Botolino recently collaborated on a nationwide investigation into judicial ethics for ProPublica and reported on Massachusetts farmworkers' working conditions in The Boston Globe. After he graduates in 2025 with a degree in journalism from Boston University, he hopes to continue to work on data-driven investigations illuminating abuses of power and failures of justice. In his spare time, he enjoys playing mediocre guitar riffs.



Peter J. Caruso, Sr.

Caruso & Caruso

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Peter J. Caruso, Sr., has represented the media in some of the most high-profile court cases in Massachusetts history since 1977. Caruso has represented print professionals in a vast spectrum of media litigation, including defamation, media and Internet law, newspaper access, advertising acceptance, news reporting, copyright and publications law. He is a Massachusetts Bar Fellow and a member of the American Bar Association and its Forum on Communications Law.



Colleen Cronin

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Colleen Cronin covers rural communities in Rhode Island for ecoRI News, a non-profit newsroom that reports on environmental and social justice issues. Prior to joining ecoRI, Cronin worked as a digital producer and metro correspondent at The Bos-

ton Globe, writing education stories and breaking news overnight. She's also worked on a year-long project investigating the opioid epidemic in Rhode Island, freelanced for The New York Times, and interned at People Magazine.



Paul Cuno-Booth

New Hampshire Public Radio

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Paul Cuno-Booth reports on health and equity for New Hampshire Public Radio. He previously worked at The Keene Sentinel for four years as a reporter and editor, and has written for the Granite State News Collaborative, BusinessNH magazine and other outlets in New Hampshire and Vermont.

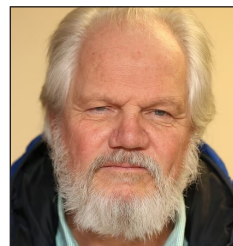


Beth Daley

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✕ [BethBDaley](#)

Beth Daley is the Executive Editor and General Manager of The Conversation US. Previously Daley had a leadership position at InsideClimate News. A Pulitzer Prize finalist for climate reporting at The Boston Globe, she also worked at the New England Center for Investigative Reporting as a reporter and director of partnerships. As Director of Strategic Development at InsideClimate, she worked to diversify the Pulitzer Prize-winning news outlet's revenue stream. Daley attended Stanford University as a John S. Knight Journalism fellow.



John R. Ellement

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John R. Ellement is an on-line journalist with 30 years of experience covering breaking news and who continues to report on criminal justice issues in Massachusetts, his primary area of expertise at bostonglobe.com. He was part of the Globe's coverage of the 2013 Boston Marathon bombing, which was awarded the Pulitzer Prize for breaking news coverage in 2014. He has worked as the Globe's primary state court reporter and covered the Boston police in the 1990s. He frequently writes the Home Of The Week feature for the Globe's Address section and boston.com/realestate.



Zeninjor Enwemeka

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✕ [Zeninjor](#)

Zeninjor Enwemeka is a senior business reporter at WBUR, Boston's NPR station, where she covers news both online and on air. She reports on business, tech and culture as part of WBUR's Bostonomix team, which focuses on the innovation economy. Before joining WBUR, she worked at The Boston Globe as a breaking

news writer for Boston.com. She also spent several years as a news/homepage producer for the website. Enwemeka was part of the 2014 Pulitzer Prize-winning team for The Boston Globe's breaking news coverage of the Boston Marathon bombings. She was also an adjunct lecturer at Boston University, where she taught a class on multimedia and online journalism. Enwemeka is a graduate of the Medill School of Journalism at Northwestern University. She serves as vice president of the Boston Association of Black Journalists.



Cindy Galli

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Cindy Galli is the Executive Producer of ABC News' award-winning Investigative Unit. She oversees a team of network cor-

respondents, reporters and producers specializing in investigations ranging from government fraud and corporate corruption to racial injustice, consumer and environmental issues. Most recently, her team was recognized with three national Edward R. Murrow Awards for investigations into racial bias in the NFL concussion settlement, the deaths of four soldiers in Niger, and the Tulsa Race Massacre. Galli also oversees collaborative investigative projects between ABC News and local stations and affiliates around the country. Galli currently serves on the board of directors for Investigative Reporters and Editors (IRE), where she has been a member since 1994.



Courtney A. Lamdin

Seven Days

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Courtney A. Lamdin is a news reporter covering the city of Burlington, Vt. for the independent weekly newspaper Seven

Days. Lamdin grew up in Central Vermont and discovered her love for reporting after reading "All the President's Men" in a high school journalism class. She studied journalism at St. Michael's College, later returning there as a part-time adjunct professor. A 2015 Negri Institute fellow, Lamdin previously worked as the executive editor of three weekly papers serving Vermont's largest county. At Seven Days, Lamdin has written extensively about police accountability, including stories that forced two police chiefs to resign in a matter of months.



Shirley Leung

The Boston Globe

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Shirley Leung is an award-winning columnist at The Boston Globe, where she covers the intersection of business, pol-

itics, and workplace gender and diversity issues. She has served as the Globe's business editor and interim editorial page editor, and was featured on Boston Magazine's list of '100 Most Influential People.' Leung currently hosts the Globe Opinion podcast "Say More," available wherever you listen to podcasts, and is a regular contributor to GBH's "Boston Public Radio." Before joining The Globe, she reported for The Wall Street Journal. A graduate of Princeton University, Leung began her career at her hometown paper, The Baltimore Sun.

18 | nefac.org



Anastasia E. Lennon

The New Bedford Light

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Anastasia Lennon joined The Light in October 2021, where she covers the fishing industry, offshore wind and police. Before

coming to The Light, she wrote about city government, police, the fishing industry and the environment for The Standard-Times. She previously worked at The Patriot Ledger in Quincy. Lennon has a bachelor's degree in history and anthropology from Stony Brook University and a master's degree in journalism from Boston University, where she taught a writing course for a semester. Lennon is a 2021 Gloria L. Negri First Amendment Institute fellow. She'll always call Long Island, New York, home, but Massachusetts has become a wonderful second home.



Sharon Machlis

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Sharon Machlis spent her career as a reporter and data professional equally at home analyzing data, coding tools for journalists, and covering technology. She most recently served director of editorial data and analytics at Foundry, which

publishes tech websites including Computerworld, CIO, PCWorld, and Macworld; and author of InfoWorld's Do More With R series. Author of "Practical R for Mass Communication and Journalism," Machlis has taught workshops at ProPublica and Investigative Reporters and Editors conferences and keynoted the 2020 European R User Meeting. She received an American Society of Business Publication Editors national gold award for impact/investigative online excellence and two ASBPE national golds for best how-to article (see 2014 and 2017 winners). Machlis was named the Digital Analytics Association's top practitioner in 2021 for work analyzing data. She also won the 2023 Neal Award for best instructional content.



Raymond A. Marcaccio

Oliverio & Marcaccio, LLP

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Raymond A. Marcaccio is the co-founder of Oliverio & Marcaccio LLP. Marcaccio enjoys a varied practice in trial and appellate advocacy, as well as conducting sensitive internal investigations concerning misconduct, discrimination and sexual harassment. He has been representing the news media for over 20 years in all facets of media law, including pre-publication review, access to public records and meetings, and defending against defamation claims.



Jenifer McKim

GBH News Center
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Jenifer McKim is the interim investigations editor with the GBH News Center for Investigative Reporting. She specializes in social justice issues

including criminal justice, child welfare and consumer debt. She has won numerous awards, including two national Edward R. Murrow Awards, a Casey Medal for Meritorious Journalism, and the Freedom of Information Award from the New England First Amendment Coalition. She was a finalist for the 2005 Pulitzer Prize in Public Service. Before joining the center in 2013, McKim worked as a staff writer at The Boston Globe, the Orange County Register in Southern California and the San Juan Star in Puerto Rico.



Judith Meyer

Sun Media Group

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Judith Meyer is executive editor of the Sun Journal, Kennebec Journal, the Morning Sentinel and seven weekly newspapers owned by the Sun Media Group. She serves as vice president of the Maine Freedom of Information Coalition and is a member of the Right to Know Advisory Committee to the Legislature. A journalist since 1990 and former editorial page editor for the Sun Journal, she was named Maine's Journalist of the Year in 2003 and was inducted in the Maine Press Association Hall of Fame in 2021. She serves on the New England Newspaper & Press Association Board of Directors and was the 2018 recipient of the Judith Vance Weld Brown Spirit of Journalism Award.



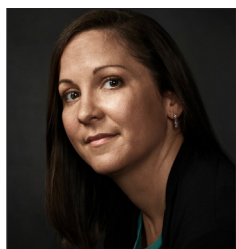
Deanna Pan

The Boston Globe

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✕ DDpan

Deanna Pan is a reporter on The Boston Globe's Great Divide team, covering race, class and opportunity in public schools, and a frequent contributor to Globe Magazine. Prior to joining The Boston Globe in 2019, she spent three years as a reporter at The Post and Courier in Charleston, S.C., reporting on K-12 schools and higher education. She was honored as a Pulitzer Prize finalist in feature writing in 2019 for her series on the unjust execution of 14-year-old George Stinney Jr., the youngest person put to death in modern U.S. history. She is also a 2020 Forbes 30 under 30 honoree in the media category. Pan started her journalism career as a staff writer for The Inlander in Spokane, Wash., writing about subjects as wide ranging as Bigfoot believers, mass shooting survivors, and insanity-defense patients. She grew up in the suburbs of Cincinnati and graduated from Ohio State University, where she changed her major almost a dozen times before settling on English.



Jacqueline Rabe Thomas

Hearst Conn. Media Group

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✕ jacquelinera

Jacqueline Rabe Thomas is an investigative reporter with Hearst Connecticut Media Group. Her reporting has led to home health care workers getting reimbursed for wages illegally taken from them, changes to the state's open record laws, rules to collect state disability pensions being updated to root out fraud, undocumented immigrants being able to access outpatient dialysis treatment and no longer having to live in the hospital to receive care, the top brass at the state's university resigning, and schools getting air quality grants. She has been a housing and education reporter with The Connecti-

cut Mirror, a reporter in ProPublica's Local Reporting Network, and an investigative reporter with WNPR's Accountability Project. She has a master's in public policy from Trinity College and a journalism degree from Bowling Green State University. She lives in Hartford with her husband, three children and two dogs.



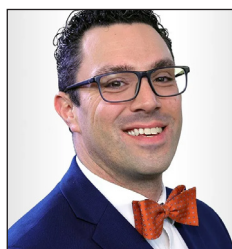
Nikita Roy

International Center for Journalists

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✕ ByNikitaRoy

As a data scientist, journalist and AI expert, it seems like Nikita Roy has an AI tool for everything — and she wants to teach journalists how to create and use their own. In her ICFJ Knight Fellowship, she will create courses to teach AI literacy and the potential rewards and risks of these transformative technologies. She will also focus on how AI can make community media more sustainable, including ways to increase revenue streams, audience reach and operational efficiency. Roy hosts the globally acclaimed Newsroom Robots podcast featuring conversations with leaders in AI and journalism about the transformation AI is bringing to the way news will be reported and consumed. Newsroom Robots has ranked among the top technology podcasts in over 30 countries on Apple Podcasts and in December 2023, Harvard University featured her as a 'Futurist' for her work on the podcast. Her digital news startup, The NRI Nation, provides news and community for the diaspora Indian community. It has been supported by ICFJ, incubated at Harvard Innovation Labs, is a two-time semifinalist at the Harvard President's Innovation Challenge and received the Harvard Innovation Lab's Spark Grant. Roy has been part of the ICFJ Leap News Innovation Lab as both a participant and a mentor, as well as a participant in the LION-Google News Initiative Startups Lab. She was spotlighted as a notable Canadian youth founder and was selected for Canada's League of Innovators Accelerator in 2022. As a generative AI specialist, she advised on the product development of a cutting-edge generative AI-based ed-tech tool at the University of Toronto. Roy's a frequent speaker and moderator at AI and journalism events. She conducts AI workshops for newsrooms and has taught generative AI at esteemed institutions, including the University of Toronto and Craig Newmark Graduate School of Journalism at the City University of New York. Her insights have been featured on Nieman Lab, Yahoo Finance and CBC. Roy is the President of the Canadian Association of Journalists - National Capital Region chapter. An alumna of the University of Toronto and Harvard University, Roy aims to foster the responsible and innovative use of AI in media, conducts workshops, develops AI products and advises on AI strategy.



Mike Savino

NBC Connecticut

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✕ Reporter_Savino

Mike Savino is the political reporter for NBC Connecticut, making sure Connecticut's government officials work on behalf of the voters. Savino is a lifelong Connecticut resident who loves telling the stories of his home state. He's an alumnus of the University of Connecticut and a graduate of E.O. Smith High School. Prior to joining NBC Connecticut, Savino worked for several newsrooms around Connecticut. He started his career as a staff writer for the Chronicle in Willimantic, then moved on to the Journal Inquirer in Manchester and the Meriden Record-Journal. He then made the switch to TV, joining a local Connecticut station.

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abridging the freedom of speech,
or of the press***

U.S. Constitution



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FIRST AMENDMENT COALITION**



Eli Sherman

WPRI 12 News

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Eli Sherman is an Emmy and Murrow award-winning journalist. He joined the 12 News investigative unit in 2019, having

previously worked as an investigative reporter for GateHouse Media. He's also covered economics for Providence Business News and worked as a metro reporter for the Waltham News Tribune. Sherman was part of the 12 News team to win a national Edward R. Murrow award for overall excellence in 2023. He's also the recipient of a New England Emmy and multiple regional Edward R. Murrow awards for investigative journalism.



Harrison Stark

ACLU of Vermont

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As a Senior Staff Attorney at the Vermont ACLU affiliate, Harrison Stark litigates a range of civil rights and civil liberties matters in state and federal court, including

cases addressing free speech, anti-discrimination, border surveillance, and government transparency. Prior to joining the ACLU of Vermont in 2021, he was an Appellate Litigation Fellow/Assistant Attorney General at the D.C. Office of the Solicitor General (OSG).



Annmarie Timmins

New Hampshire Public Radio

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Annmarie Timmins is a reporter at New Hampshire Public Radio. She recently worked as a senior reporter at New Hampshire

Bulletin. Timmins is a New Hampshire native who covered state government, courts, and social justice issues for the Concord Monitor for 25 years. During her time with the Monitor, she won a Nieman Fellowship to study journalism and mental health courts at Harvard for a year. She has taught journalism at the University of New Hampshire and writing at the Mackey S. Loeb School of Communications.



Gal Tziperman Lotan

GBH News

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✕ [tzigal](#)

Gal Tziperman Lotan is a digital producer for GBH's Morning Edition. Before coming to GBH, she covered policing and

other general assignment topics for the Boston Globe's metro section. Prior to that she was a reporter for The Orlando Sentinel in Florida, covering the criminal legal system, policing, and the Pulse nightclub shooting in 2016.



Todd Wallack

WBUR

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✕ [TWallack](#)

Todd Wallack has been the deputy managing editor in WBUR's newsroom since March 2021. As part of that role, he oversees

a team of reporters who cover politics, criminal justice, and general news. Previously, Wallack spent 14 years as a reporter at the Boston Globe, including eight as an investigative and data reporter on the Globe's Spotlight Team. Wallack has also worked at several other newspapers, including the San Francisco Chronicle, Boston Herald, and the Dayton (Ohio) Daily News.



Brooke Williams

Boston University

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✕ [reporterbrooke](#)

Brooke Williams is an investigative reporter, professor of the practice of computational journalism, and co-founder of

the Justice Media Computational co-Lab at Boston University. Her data-driven investigative reporting has contributed to a Pulitzer Prize for Investigative Reporting, a George Polk Award and a Gerald Loeb Award, among many others. As a contributor to The New York Times, she co-authored and built the database behind a series of front-page investigations into think tanks, foreign governments, corporations and influence.

Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of **religion**, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the freedom of **speech**, or of the **press**; or the right of the people peaceably to **assemble**, and to **petition** the government for a redress of grievances.

First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution

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Investigation launch



5 months later



At Hearst Connecticut Media Group, we strive to produce journalism that changes lives for the better, moves people in power to act and sheds light on problems that affect our communities.

Over many years, the largest city in Connecticut had developed a notorious reputation for thumbing its nose at transparency by routinely stonewalling and delaying turning over even the most basic public records. But just hours after our newsroom published a three-part series exposing Bridgeport's repeated violations of the state's public records law, Mayor Joe Ganim announced a host of reforms to address problems highlighted by our reporting. The series uncovered similar FOIA failures across the state prompting Connecticut lawmakers to pass legislation to strengthen the state's open records law for the first time in nearly 40 years.

In big ways and small ways, Hearst Connecticut Media Group works each day to help improve the lives of residents in our towns, cities and our state - by producing journalism that makes a difference.

Hearst Connecticut Media Group commends this year's honorees of the Connecticut Foundation for Open Government's Mitchell W. Pearlman Freedom of Information Award.

2024 Fellows



Ben Berke

The Public's Radio

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Ben Berke reports on Massachusetts' South Coast for The Public's Radio. He covers anything that happens in Fall River, New Bedford, and the surrounding towns, as long as it's a good story. His sound-rich radio features have taken listeners inside factories, fishing vessels, city halls, jails, bakeries, art studios, environmental cleanup sites and the homes of hundreds of interview subjects. Berke joined the The Public's Radio in February 2021 after three years in Brockton reporting for The Enterprise. His freelance work has appeared in The New York Times, The Boston Globe and The Providence Journal.



Anna Coon

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Anna Coon is a multimedia journalist at WGME-TV in Portland, Maine. She currently works as a general assignment reporter, and often covers city council, local politics, and breaking news. Prior to her role in Portland, she worked in the archives department for NBC News in Washington, DC. Coon is a graduate of the University of Miami, where she spent many hours at her college television station, UMTV. She grew up in Sharon, Connecticut and is thrilled to be learning among fellow New Englanders.



Emma Cotton

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Emma Cotton covers the environment, climate change, energy and agriculture for VTDigger. She graduated from Report for America in 2023. Previously, she covered Rutland and Bennington counties for VTDigger, wrote for the Addison Independent and served as assistant editor of Vermont Sports and VT Ski + Ride magazines. She studied marine science and journalism at Eckerd College in St. Petersburg, Florida.



Will Dowd

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Will Dowd is a community journalist and editor with 15 years of experience covering local and state news in Massachusetts. He currently serves as the community editor for the Marblehead Current, a nonprofit newspaper that he co-founded in 2022 to serve the town's 20,000 residents. Dowd's journalism career began in 2012 when he joined the Marblehead Reporter. Since that time,

his beats have spanned Cambridge, Salem and Swampscott. His reporting has been recognized for spot news, feature writing and environmental reporting. Prior to his journalism career, Dowd dedicated two years to full-time national service. From 2009 to 2011, he served as an AmeriCorps*VISTA coordinator in North Shore Community College's Public Policy Institute, where he developed a civic education program and taught teenagers about the policymaking process.



Grace Ferguson

The New Bedford Light

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Grace Ferguson is an enterprise reporter for The New Bedford Light, focusing on housing and transportation. Her investigations for The Light have uncovered how private investors profited from tax foreclosures, exposed the ways anonymous landlords can harm tenants, and mapped thousands of dangerous lead pipes delivering water to homes. Before coming to The Light, she was a fellow for WBUR in Boston, where she contributed public records research to award-winning police misconduct investigations. Before that, she was a FOIA intern at the internet-focused news site The Daily Dot. Her investigative work on housing in western Massachusetts has been aired by GBH News in Boston.



Jake Freudberg

Morning Sentinel

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Jake Freudberg covers Skowhegan, Maine, and the surrounding area of Somerset County for the Morning Sentinel, a daily newspaper based in Waterville, Maine. Before arriving to central Maine in November 2023, Freudberg reported for GBH News, Boston.com, El Mundo Boston, and the Appalachian Mountain Club's magazine while in college. He graduated from Tufts University in May 2022, where he was a sports reporter and editor for The Tufts Daily, the school's independent student newspaper. His degree is in Film and Media Studies, Spanish, and Education. He grew up in the Boston area, and before moving to Maine last year had spent five summers working as a whitewater rafting guide in Maine on the Kennebec, Penobscot, and Dead Rivers. This summer was his sixth as he bounced between the newsroom and the river.

2024 JAMES W. FOLEY SCHOLAR



Sruthi Gopalakrishnan

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Sruthi Gopalakrishnan is a reporter for the Concord Monitor, covering stories on waste management, landfills, casinos and mental health. She joined the Monitor in 2022 after earning a master's degree in investigative reporting from Northwestern University. She enjoys working with data, to create maps and charts that complement her reporting.



Liz Hardaway

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Liz Hardaway is a breaking news reporter with Hearst Connecticut Media Group who covers crime, court proceedings and human services issues. Before joining the team, she was a Hearst fellow in Connecticut and at the San Antonio Express-News where she covered city hall and local issues like homelessness. She also worked at Sun Coast Media Group in Southwest Florida as a general assignment reporter covering politics, business and health. Hardaway graduated from Ohio Wesleyan University in 2018 with a B.A. in journalism. She enjoys cooking, reading and playing with her dachshund, Finn.



Colin Hogan

The New Bedford Light

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Colin Hogan is the education reporter at the New Bedford Light, a nonprofit and nonpartisan newsroom dedicated to enterprise and investigative journalism. Hogan has covered the decline of school libraries, the crisis-level shortage of early childhood education in Massachusetts, the fight to keep or remove LGBTQ+ books from South Coast schools, and other topics. Before journalism, Hogan worked as a public school teacher in Mississippi and New York City.



Anjali Huynh

The Boston Globe

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Anjali Huynh is a political reporter at the Boston Globe, where she primarily covers the Massachusetts State House and New England politics. Previously, she was a politics fellow at the New York Times, where she was a breaking news and campaign reporter who covered 2024 races from a dozen states. Her work focused on presidential and Senate primary contests, and she wrote about anything from Latino voters in Nevada to how candidates were approaching TikTok. Before that, Huynh covered the 2022 Georgia midterm elections and local news for the Atlanta Journal-Constitution and was an intern with NBC News, the Globe's breaking news team, and CNN.



Nancy Lavin

Rhode Island Current

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Nancy Lavin is the senior reporter covering state politics, energy and environmental issues for the Rhode Island Current, a part of national nonprofit States Newsroom. She has over a decade of experience working for daily newspapers in Rhode Island and Maryland, covering everything from state and local government to business, banking and demographics.



Charlotte Matherly

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Charlotte Matherly is the Statehouse Reporter for the Concord Monitor & Monadnock Ledger-Transcript in New Hampshire and a Report for America corps member. She previously reported on government and education in Virginia as a freelancer and has interned at The Chronicle of Higher Education and at a business journal in Richmond, Virginia, for the Dow Jones News Fund. Matherly pursued journalism on a whim when she joined her campus newspaper, The Breeze, at James Madison University. Immediately hooked, she became an award-winning features editor, then editor-in-chief, and earned her bachelor's degree in media arts and design. Matherly has a deep passion and commitment for holding powerful people to account and making government actions more accessible and transparent for citizens. When not poring over public records or holed up at a government meeting (which is rare), Matherly loves to roller skate, explore new cities and frequent local coffee shops.



Catherine McLaughlin

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Catherine McLaughlin is a reporter at the Concord Monitor covering the City of Concord with an emphasis on local government. Previously, she worked at the Laconia Daily Sun as a general assignment reporter where she focused on education and regional politics. She studied political science at Middlebury College. Born and raised in Gilford, New Hampshire, she's a lover of all things lakes and mountains.

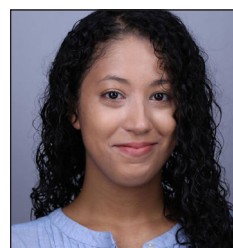


Shaun Robinson

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Shaun Robinson covers state government and politics in Vermont for VTDigger. Previously, he was VTDigger's northwestern Vermont reporter, covering local government and schools in several counties along the U.S.-Canada border. He was also a member of Report for America, a national service program for journalists. Robinson graduated from Boston University in 2021 where he studied journalism and political science.



Jeniece Roman

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Jeniece Roman is a reporter with WSHU Public Radio in Fairfield, CT. She writes about Indigenous communities in southern New England and Long Island, New York. She joined WSHU as a 2022 Report for America Corps member and launched workshops for local youth on journalism, media literacy, and misinformation.

Previously, Roman covered local government and education for the New Britain Herald in New Britain, Connecticut, and was a breaking news and crime reporter for the Record-Journal newspaper in Meriden. Currently, she is the VP of Programming for the Connecticut Society of Professional Journalists Pro Chapter. She organizes networking events, workshops, and training for journalists in the state.



Namu Sampath

The Republican

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Namu Sampath (she/her) is a reporter at The Republican in Springfield, Mass., where she covers daily and enterprise stories. She is originally from San Diego, California, but lived in Boston for seven years before her move to the Pioneer Valley. When she's not chasing a story, you can find her (binge) watching TV shows, spending time with friends and family or traveling.



Chris Shea

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✕ **KRISH_EH**

Christopher Shea covers politics, cannabis, transportation and housing for Rhode Island Current. He previously was editor of Dartmouth Week for nearly two years after rising from a reporter position. During his time there, he broke the story in Massachusetts of the closure of the former ICE facility at the Bristol County House of Corrections. A Wisconsin native who is fluent in Spanish, Shea graduated from the University of Minnesota and interned at The Minneapolis Star Tribune.



Jessica Simms

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Jessica Simms is a Hearst Connecticut Media reporter covering education in Greenwich. She attended Quinnipiac University where she received both her BA and MS in journalism. Simms has worked at the Record-Journal in Meriden and she was an investigative reporting fellow with the News21 program at the Walter Cronkite School of Journalism in the summer of 2021.



Rob Smith

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Rob Smith is a reporter for ecoRI News, where he covers environmental policy in the state legislature, and watchdogs Rhode Island's environmental agencies. Prior to joining ecoRI News, Rob worked as news editor and staff writer for Motif Magazine, a bimonthly alt-paper located in Pawtucket, covering politics, Providence and social justice issues. He got his start in journalism as a sophomore at Rhode Island College, when he joined the student radio station.



Alex Torres-Perez

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Alex Torres-Perez is an award-winning journalist at WPRI 12 News. She joined the team as a general assignment reporter in August 2023. She's also a part of the 12 Informa reporting team, which brings local news in Spanish to Hispanics in Southern New England. Originally from Puerto Rico, Torres-Perez noticed the importance of having access to local news in Spanish when she moved to Florida. She started a weekly Spanish newscast when she first started her career in Huntsville, AL to make sure Spanish-speaking residents had access to important information. She received a Google grant to expand that newscast to daily during the pandemic. In her five years in Huntsville, Torres-Perez wore several hats as an anchor, producer, reporter and photographer. She won the Alabama Broadcast Association's award for Television Local Programming with "The Next Giant Leap," where she helped showcase how North Alabama played a role in the first Artemis mission launch to the Moon. She was also a part of several major projects including coverage of the 80th anniversary of Pearl Harbor in Hawaii. Torres-Perez was also at the forefront of pushing for legislative change. She held lawmakers accountable after an officer was shot and killed by a man who was let out of prison early because of a state law. After several visits and persistent questioning, the Sgt. Nick Risner Act was passed. Torres-Perez graduated with a Bachelor's in Multimedia Journalism from the University of North Florida (Swoop!) in Jacksonville, Florida. She was managing editor of the college newspaper Spinnaker and helped students with her work at the university's School of Communication.



Dylan Tusinski

Morning Sentinel

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Dylan Tusinski covers about a dozen rural communities with the Morning Sentinel in central Maine, reporting on everything from breaking news and international crime syndicates to blueberry farms and local government. He has written with the Sentinel since 2023, balancing daily reporting on council meetings and house fires with long-term investigations into drug smuggling, homelessness and more. Transparency and accountability are the cornerstones of everything he writes, whether that be stories on alleged abuses of power by small town police chiefs or investigations into human trafficking at illegal marijuana grows throughout rural Maine. Tusinski moved to Maine from Colorado, where he graduated from Colorado State University in 2023 after several years working as a reporter, graphic designer and photographer with The Rocky Mountain Collegian, one of the oldest student-run publications in the country. His work there largely focused on the intersections between public power and student interest in student, local and state governments. Tusinski received Colorado State's 2023 Ethical Practices in Journalism Award for his coverage of a student media executive and student presidential candidate's violations of university election codes. His reporting on student and local politics with the paper was also nominated for the 2022 Society of Professional Journalists' Mark of Excellence Award. When Tusinski is not sitting in on a town council meeting, he can usually be found at the nearest Grateful Dead cover band show or watching his favorite hockey team, the New York Islanders, lose their next game.



Laura Ullman

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Laura Ullman (all pronouns) is a multimedia journalist and passionate storyteller from New York. Ullman's journey

in reporting began at the University of Texas at Austin, where they studied radio, television, film, journalism, and political philosophy. They were active in Austin's vibrant live music and arts scene. During university, Ullman also earned their divemaster certification on Oahu's North Shore, where they further explored their passion for documentary filmmaking and surfing. Ullman's academic pursuits took them to London, Brighton and Madrid, where they received both first place and an honorable mention for the Moody Abroad Photojournalism Scholarship. This international experience led to an internship opportunity at WCAX in Vermont. There, under the mentorship of Roger Garrity, Ullman started as a weekend morning producer and multimedia journalist. Now, as the Channel 3 Reporter at 11, Ullman covers health care while maintaining a broad curiosity.



Marie Weidmayer

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Marie Weidmayer is the crime and justice reporter at the Bangor Daily News, a daily newspaper based in Bangor, Maine, the state's third largest city. She joined the paper in August 2023 and primarily covers criminal cases, lawsuits and police accountability. Weidmayer, who was born and raised in Michigan, began her professional career in 2019, covering criminal justice at the Jackson Citizen Patriot, in Michigan, before moving to the Kalamazoo Gazette. She attended Michigan State University, where she earned degrees in journalism and Arabic. While in school, she covered the Larry Nassar sexual abuse cases and university-wide fallout for The State News, an independent student newspaper.



Abby Weiss

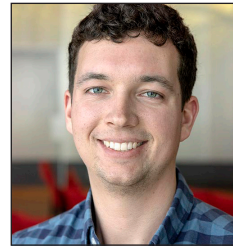
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Abby Weiss is a Connecticut native and features reporter for Hearst Connecticut Media Group. She writes about entertain-

ment, interesting people in Connecticut and the state's history. Weiss also writes enterprise stories about gender issues and the environment. She graduated with a B.S. in journalism at the S.I. Newhouse School of Public Communications at Syracuse University in May 2022. Weiss has written climate stories for InsideClimate News and Callaway Climate Insights, and interned for The New York Post. In college, Weiss minored in history and environmental science and wrote for multiple campus publications, including The Daily Orange. There, she served as the student-run newspaper's digital managing editor and wrote an award-winning story about President Joe Biden's time at Syracuse. She's a big fan of Harry Potter and her dog, Rory.



Walter Wuthmann

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Walter Wuthmann is WBUR's state politics reporter, covering the State House with a focus on accountability and enterprise reporting. He previously covered Boston City Hall and breaking news. His story on ousted Massachusetts police officers moving from one department to the next won the Public Media Journalists Association award for investigative reporting and was a finalist for the Alfred I. duPont-Columbia University Award. Wuthmann graduated from Bowdoin College and then worked at the Forecaster, a weekly newspaper in Portland, Maine. He spent a year working for an English-language newspaper in Sri Lanka on a fellowship, reporting on politics, development and post-war reconstruction in the island's capital.

We would like to acknowledge

**THE ROBERTSON FOUNDATION
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**for their generosity and continued support
of the First Amendment, the public's right to know and the
education of journalists throughout New England.**

2024 Student Fellows

NEFAC is pleased to announce its second class of student journalism fellows. With the support of the Rhode Island Foundation and the Estate of Gloria L. Negri, the coalition accepted this year a group of student journalists to attend along with 25 professional reporters, editors and producers from newsrooms throughout New England. The students were all nominated by faculty members at their respective Rhode Island or Massachusetts schools.



Juliannie Ayala
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Juliannie Ayala was born and raised in Boston and is currently a senior at the University of Massachusetts Amherst. She is a double major in Journalism and Legal Studies. As an aspiring journalist, Ayala's goal is to give a voice to the voiceless, especially in marginalized communities. She is currently a new member of a group on campus called the Rebirth Project which highlights and displays voices of marginalized students.



Caitlyn A. Bailey
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Caitlyn A. Bailey is a senior English communications major with minors in French studies and creative writing at Salve Regina University. Originally from Norton, Mass. Bailey serves as the editor-in-chief for The Mosaic, Salve Regina's student-run school newspaper. The platform has given her the opportunity to not only further her own writing skills, but also to guide other members of the Salve Regina community in finding their own stories that they want to tell.



Ava Berger
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Ava Berger is a senior at Boston University studying Journalism and Spanish. Ava, from Dallas, TX, is a former Features Editor at BU's independent student newspaper, The Daily Free Press, and she is currently the president of the nonprofit, Back Bay Publishing Company, which runs the newspaper. She was the Spring 2024 City/Express Desk correspondent at The Boston Globe where she covered crime scenes, fires, the Celtics 18th Championship, and more.



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Sonel Cutler is a fourth-year journalism and political science student at Northeastern University. She currently serves as the Editor-in-Chief of the Huntington News, Northeastern's independent student newspaper. She previously worked as a reporting intern for the Chronicle of Higher Education in Washington, D.C., covering issues and trends at colleges across the country.



Maria Gabriela De Leon
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Maria Gabriela De Leon was born and raised in Guatemala City, Guatemala. At 15 years old, she moved to the United States but returned to Guatemala five months later to help a sick family member. She returned to the United States two years later in the middle of the COVID-19 pandemic and finished her high school degree online. It was during her time at a community college that Castro found an interest in communications.



Hannah Nguyen
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Hannah Nguyen is a senior journalism major at Emerson College in Boston and is expected to graduate in December 2024. Originally from Montgomery County, Penn. Nguyen currently serves as the editor-in-chief of The Berkeley Beacon, Emerson's only independent and student-run newspaper. She has previously interned at The Boston Globe, The Philadelphia Inquirer, and North Penn Now, and has bylines in Cambridge Day and AsAmNews.



Ellie Sennhenn
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Ellie Sennhenn is a third-year honors student at the University of Rhode Island, double majoring in Journalism and Public and Professional Writing. She is from Audubon, New Jersey. Aspiring travel and investigative journalist, Sennhenn has taken a variety of courses at URI with the goal of diversifying her perspectives — including communications, poetry, ethics, politics, disability, grief and representation.



Alexandra Tavaglione
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Alexandra Tavaglione is a junior studying at Roger Williams University in Bristol RI. She is majoring in journalism with minors in photography, sports studies, and legal studies. Her goal after graduation is to become a sports photographer, ideally in baseball.

The value of
journalism
isn't measured
in dollars;
it's measured
in change.

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